

Secure Funder™

Independent Certification for Responsible Submission Handling in Alternative Finance

Program URL: <https://securefunder.org/>

Purpose

Secure Funder™ establishes a practical, independently verified baseline for how alternative finance organizations handle submissions and the sensitive documents associated with them. The focus is simple: protect submissions as they move through your existing workflows.

What We Evaluate

*Equivalent controls are accepted when they meet the intent of a requirement and can be verified.

Funders typically receive submissions via email, API, and/or portal. We review—via structured live screen-share (no system access, no recordings)—how those submissions are handled once received.

- Who has access to incoming submissions?
- What can they do with that access? (view, download, export)
- Is intake automated into the CRM, or does it require human handling?
- If human handling occurs, are documents protected during that process? (e.g. watermarked)
- Are documents view-only or downloadable and watermarked to deter misuse or unauthorized redistribution?

There is no required technology stack and no single "correct" workflow. The standard centers on whether reasonable safeguards exist to reduce preventable risk—particularly once documents can be downloaded or redistributed.

Full certification requirements: www.securefunder.org/certification

What This Is Not

Secure Funder™ is not a SOC 2 replacement, a comprehensive audit, or a paid directory listing. It is an independently administered certification program designed to establish practical baseline standards and clearly distinguish organizations operating with verified safeguards to protect their partners and merchants.

Process

- [Enroll](#) and provide a logo for directory listing.
- Enroll prior to April 1 to receive Charter Member designation.
- Schedule verification session within 90 days (extensions available in certain circumstances).
- Verification is conducted via non-recorded screen share. No system access is requested or granted.

Annual Membership

\$2,499 per year. No payment is due until verification is scheduled. Includes independent verification process, public directory listing, membership visibility at sponsored industry events, continued program alignment as state-level expectations evolve, and digital certification badge.